

Zakira Farheen

Senior DevOps · SRE · DevSecOps Engineer

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SUMMARY

Senior DevOps, SRE, and DevSecOps engineer with 15+ years making infrastructure that is fast to deploy, hard to break, and secure by design. I build and run cloud-native platforms and CI/CD for demanding, regulated environments (Aviva, Lloyds Bank): defining SLOs and error budgets, replacing manual releases with automation, and baking security into the pipeline from the start. If a team needs to ship faster without breaking things, and keep delivery auditable under strict controls, that is the problem I solve.

CORE SKILLS

Cloud: AWS, Azure, GCP	Reliability/SRE: SLOs, error budgets, incident response, RCA
Infrastructure as code: Terraform, policy-as-code	DevSecOps: SAST, container scanning, secrets management
CI/CD: Jenkins, Azure DevOps	Practices: Chaos engineering, observability, monitoring & alerting
Containers: Docker, Kubernetes	Domains: Financial services, regulated/compliance environments

EXPERIENCE

Principal DevOps Engineer

Feb 2026 – Present

Cyber Resiliency Labs · Ontario, Canada

- Lead the DevOps practice, helping businesses and non-profits ship software faster and run it reliably, securely, and cost-effectively.
- Design and operate CI/CD pipelines and the cloud infrastructure underneath, building on AWS and Terraform with delivery automation across teams.
- Advise teams on reliability and DevSecOps: SLOs, monitoring, incident response, and security built into the pipeline rather than bolted on.

Senior DevOps Engineer

Jan 2024 – Present

Aviva Canada · Toronto, ON

- Keep the Guidewire platform dependable on AWS, using Terraform and automation to make releases routine and recovery fast.
- Built the monitoring and alerting that surfaces production issues before they reach customers, cutting unplanned downtime.
- Own root-cause analysis and incident response, turning outages into fixes that stop the same problem recurring.

Lead DevOps / Cloud Consultant

May 2021 – Jan 2024

Aviva UK · United Kingdom

- Led Aviva UK's DevOps and cloud transformation, replacing manual releases with fully automated pipelines that ship faster and break less.
- Standardized infrastructure on Azure with Terraform and brought CI/CD discipline across delivery teams through Jenkins and Azure DevOps.
- Ran cross-cloud workloads on AWS and coached teams to invest in pipeline quality, which paid back in fewer late-stage failures.

Senior DevOps Engineer

Jan 2019 – May 2021

Lloyds Bank, UK

- Rebuilt the CI/CD pipeline for a suite of .NET applications at one of the UK's largest banks, moving delivery onto AWS and GCP with full automation.
- Replaced slow, manual releases with automated ones, so the team shipped faster and with far more confidence.
- Held delivery speed and strict security, compliance, and audit controls in balance, a non-negotiable in banking.

Senior DevOps Engineer

Apr 2017 – Jan 2019

Lloyds Bank, UK

- Built CI/CD pipelines for .NET applications and migrated workloads to AWS and GCP.
- Took manual steps out of deployment and made pipelines more reliable, while keeping everything auditable under strict change control.

Technology Analyst

Aug 2010 – Aug 2015

Nordstrom, US

- Owned release engineering and build management for a large retail environment: artifact versioning, builds, and deployments to on-premise infrastructure.
- Mapped the full path from commit to production end to end, the groundwork for the pipeline automation that followed.

EDUCATION

M.Eng, Embedded Systems & VLSI Design

2008 – 2010

B.Tech, Electronics & Communication Engineering

2004 – 2008

CERTIFICATIONS

- HashiCorp Certified: Terraform Associate
- AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner
- Microsoft Certified: DevOps Engineer (AZ-400)
- Professional Scrum Master I
- IBM Certified Solution Advisor: Cloud Computing Architecture V5